

Editorial

Dear Readers,

The BIG news is the release of Lenny (Debian 5), which is perhaps the best Valentine's Day gift a free software enthusiast could have expected. Debian releases have always been special, particularly because you do not see a new 'stable' release from this project every semester or so, unlike most others. Although many do run the 'unstable' or 'test' versions, every 'stable' version still merits special attention because, as a popular Slashdot quote goes, "They don't release things until you have to fire rockets at the thing to stop it from working."

We, at LFY, are overwhelmed by the amount of enquiries we have received about when we shall be including Lenny with the magazine. Although many of you might have looked forward to it being bundled with the March issue, we could not—unfortunately—because it was released in the middle of the month, and although we were aware of the previous announcement of the release date, we were not sure if it will go live for certain and therefore could not plan it in. So, guess you have to wait for another month. But hey, I think we can make up for the disappointment. This month's DVD has Slackware, which is another of the few distros that likes to concentrate only on things that are 'stable'. You can certainly bet your mission-critical stuff on it.

KDE 4.2 was another significant release, and the awesome desktop experience has left many of us speechless. Err... correction... one of our team members seems to have been overly verbose rather than tongue-tied while filing a report on it! Anyway, we hope you also enjoy the release as much as we did. Try it out from the Live CD included this month.

Moving on, Linux on the mobile (and mobile devices) has been all over the news in February. Well, it has actually been in the news for more than a year now. But, I am talking about the number of announcements and releases made last month, especially with respect to Android, followed by LiMo—a website like LinuxDevices.com pulls out

around 20-30 updates. This includes lots of announcements from Chinese manufacturers; rumours on Dell also entering the mobile phone space with an Android-powered device; the delay in the release of Motorola's Windows Mobile-powered phones, and plans to concentrate on Android; besides HTC's second generation Android phones to be released in Europe this spring (hmm... what about India? :-)).

Hopefully, we will get to hear the buzz from India on this front during the dedicated seminar that has been planned as part of Open Source India (OSI) Tech Days 2009. The seminar, titled 'FOSS-powered mobile phones and devices' is scheduled for March 13, and despite being a half-day session it seems to have the highest number of registrations

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amongst all other seminars planned during the conference.

I must thank all of you for the great support in shaping up OSI. It is turning out to be an event that we are all looking forward to. Hope to meet many of you at the Chennai Trade Centre on March 12, 2009.

Best Wishes!



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